

III ① The goals of the prize-givers seem as scattered^① as the criticism. ② Some want to shock, others to draw people into science, or to better reward those who have made their careers in research.

授奖者的目的似乎和批评一样分散。有的想要引起轰动,其他人想吸引公众走进科学,或者想要更好地奖励那些在研究中有所成就的人们。

• 词汇注释与难句分析 •



① scattered ['skæɪtəd] a. 分散的

① draw... into... (把……吸引入……)

② make one's career (在事业上有所成就)

● 经典搭配

• 语篇分析 •



第三段介绍新奖项被设立的目的。关键词为:goals。

①句过渡,承上指出奖项出资者的目的和批评一样多样。the criticism 回应第二段少数科学家对新奖项的批评;as scattered as... 开启本段对设奖者目的的论述,scattered 本意为“四散的,散乱的”,此处形容企业家设奖目的不一,各不相同。

②句例证①句,列举几种主要目的。Some want to... 先引出一些不纯目的;shock 略去宾语(即“受众”),泛指“震惊所有人”,即旨在快速成名。others want to... , or (want) to... 引出其他人的积极目的:引大众关注科研、鼓励科研成就者;句中 career 并非“职业”,而是指“事业的(成就、成功)”。

【深层解读】本段表面上客观介绍了互联网大佬设立新奖项的各种目的,但 Some..., others..., or... 中 some 仅为“少数人”,others..., or... 实为“其余大多数人”,故作者传递的信息为:“居心不良者”只是少数,大多数用意是好的,所以侧面驳斥了上段一些人的质疑(设奖目的在于自我炒作)。

IV ① As Nature has pointed out before, there are some legitimate concerns about how science prizes — both new and old — are distributed^①. ② The Breakthrough Prize in Life Sciences, launched this year, takes an unrepresentative view of what the life sciences include. ③^[34] But the Nobel Foundation's limit of three recipients^② per prize, each of whom must still be living, has long been outgrown^③ by the collaborative^④ nature of modern research — as will be demonstrated by the inevitable row^⑤ over who is ignored when it comes to acknowledging the discovery of the Higgs boson^⑥. ④^[34] The Nobels were, of course, themselves set up by a very rich individual who had decided what he wanted to do with his own money. ⑤ Time, rather than intention, has given them legitimacy^⑦.

正如《自然》曾指出的,人们在科学奖项——无论新旧——如何分配的问题上有些顾虑是合理的。今年推出的“生命科学突破奖”对生命科学这一学科的内涵认定就不具有代表性。但是诺贝尔基金会的限定——每个奖项获奖人数不超三人,且必须都在世——早就因为现代研究的协作性质而不再适用了,这一点会在确认希格斯玻色子的发现时得到证明,因为届时必然会出现关于“哪位(科学家)遭到忽视”的争论。当然,诺贝尔奖本身也是由非常富有的个人设立,由他决定想用自己的钱做什么。(不过)赋予诺贝尔奖正统地位的是时间,而非动机。

• 词汇注释与难句分析 •



① distribute [dɪ'strɪbjʊt] v. 分配,分散

⑤ row [raʊ] n. 争论,争议

② recipient [rɪ'sɪpiənt] n. 接受者,领受者

⑥ boson ['bəʊzɒn] n. 玻色子

③ outgrow [aʊt'grəʊ] v. 长得太大了而不适用于

⑦ legitimacy [lɪ'dʒɪtɪməsi] n. 合法性,正统性

④ collaborative [kə'læbəreɪtɪv] a. 合力的,协作的

● 经典搭配